

In Jordan Peele's film *Get Out*, the moment that turns the whole story inside out is quiet and almost casual. Chris stands in the hallway of the Armitage house, suitcase in hand, begging Rose for the car keys so they can escape. She digs through her bag, looks up, and says, "You know I can't give you the keys, right?" Until that instant, the film has played as an uneasy but familiar story about a Black boyfriend visiting his white girlfriend's comfortable, liberal family. When she refuses, the mask falls. The scene makes something clear. The real threat is not open hatred. It is affection that turns out to be ownership.

This shift raises a deeper problem. How do you represent a kind of racism that does not sound like racism, that looks like admiration and care, and that even insists it is on your side? *Get Out* is not just about obvious bigots. The Armitages praise Black athletes, collect African art, date Black partners, and brag that they would have voted for Obama a third time. Yet their business model depends on using Black bodies as material for white renewal. Peele has said that he wrote the film during the Obama years, when many people insisted that racism was "over" and that calling it out was the real problem. He calls that era the "postracial lie."